developed with the land. They had intimate knowledge of particular territories associated with their tribal beliefs. The rocks, bushes, rivers, flora, and fauna of the landscape were the spiritual home of their ancestors and deserved respect. The Aborigines had no desire for individual acquisitiveness in their material life: all food and artifacts were shared among the group in a spirit of mutuality that satisfied communal needs. Sharing provided mutual help in times of scarcity. They had no need to acquire land through the capitalist practices. They had no legal procedures or the expansionist mentality of the foreign settlers. Thus, there were relatively few instances of Aborigines raiding the territorial lands of other tribes. Identity with the land was both an intellectual and economic feature of Aboriginal life. Indigenous people connected their whole lives to the prophecies of the ‘Dreaming’ stories, which explained how they should conduct themselves.

The Aborigines adjusted to climate change by monitoring the habitats of plants, game animals, and rock holes. They improved various tools such as the digging stick, spatula, fishing nets, boomerangs, ‘woomera’, hammers and spears. Their hunter-gatherer lifestyle did not remain static but altered according to new ecological and climate changes. Aboriginal work was important for sheep farmers in Western Australia and in central Queensland. They worked as domestic laborers in mining camps in northern and central Australia. By 1900, there were around 10,000 Aborigines working for the Europeans.